



Security update for Samba 3.3

A critical security hole has forced the Samba developers to release an update for the 3.3 branch, which is due to be discontinued soon. The flaw allows certain memory areas to be overwritten via specially crafted packets; in most cases, this triggers a server crash, but potentially it can also be exploited to remotely inject and execute code. All versions from 3.0.x, up to and including 3.3.12, are affected. Updating to 3.3.13 (direct download) closes the hole. The developers recommend that affected administrators install the new version as soon as possible. Versions 3.4.x and 3.5.x are not vulnerable. More at: <http://bit.ly/Samba3>

SHOUTcast removed from VLC from 1.1.0 onwards

From a press release on VideoLAN.org comes this information:

"SHOUTcast Radio is a website that provides a directory of radio stations available on the Internet. It provides categorisations of such stations, so it is easier to find one that matches your interest. According to user feedback, the integration of such a directory inside VLC is (was) one of the best features of the software."

Starting from VLC 1.1.0, the SHOUTcast module is not available on the distributed VLC any longer, because AOL Corporation is hindering open source software. During the last year, the VLC developers have received several injunctions by e-mail from employees at AOL, asking them to either comply to a licence not compatible with free software or remove the SHOUTcast capability in VLC. Moreover, the licence forces them to integrate the spyware- and adware-based SHOUTcast Radio Toolbar inside their browser as stated in chapter 6.6. Read more on this at: <http://bit.ly/VLC1-1>



Novell's new PlateSpin 'smart workload management' products

PlateSpin is the industry's first workload-management solution that spans Linux and Windows environments, addressing the server migration and disaster recovery needs of heterogeneous physical and virtual server environments.

Intelligent workload management (IWM) has been Novell's key strategy since December 2009, to reduce the challenges of computing across physical, virtual and cloud environments, while still granting users secure and compliant access to the full computing services. The recent launch of the Migrate, Protect and Forge versions of PlateSpin is a cherry topping for the seamless workload management cake.

The new products offer live migrations of workloads from physical to virtual, virtual to physical, and physical to physical environments—regardless of the OS platform. The PlateSpin products provide a simple path to the

WordPress 3.0 adds multi-site support

The popular open source blogging and publishing platform is now at version 3.0, code-named Thelonious. With over 2,700 changes, it merges WordPress MU (multi-user) and WordPress, allowing users to manage multiple sites using the same installation. A new menu management feature has been added and child theme support has been improved. The release includes a new default Twenty Ten theme, replacing the Kubrick theme. Other changes include support for custom theme backgrounds and the ability to bulk update themes. More at: <http://bit.ly/WordPress3-0>

Mozilla releases Thunderbird 3.0.5

Mozilla developers have released version 3.0.5 of the open source e-mail and news client, addressing over 60 bugs and adding performance improvements for message indexing and accessing profiles stored on a network. The developers advise all users to update to the latest release.

The next major release, version 3.1, is based on the Gecko 1.9.2 platform and is due later this month. More at: <http://bit.ly/Thunderbird3-0-5>

Google command line tool

GoogleCL is a command line utility that provides access to various Google services. It streamlines tasks such as posting to a Blogger blog, adding events to Calendar, or editing documents on Google Docs. It is a pure Python application that uses the Python gdata libraries to make Google Data API calls from the command line. Read more at the GoogleCL project page: <http://bit.ly/GoogleCL1>